

U.S. IT Hardware

APPLE TRACKER (April): iPhone revenue up 6% YoY in a shrinking market



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The Apple Tracker breaks down the latest data on iPhone sales and services from Counterpoint and Sensor Tower, and analyzes what this means for Apple and the supply chain. For more on our Apple views see our [Apple Deep Dive](#).

Global iPhone April sell-through revenue grew 5.6% YoY, with unit volumes up 2.5% and ASP up 3%. Although YoY growth appears to slow this is somewhat due to tough comps in April 2025 (tariff announcements), and is remarkable performance in a shrinking market. Counterpoint estimates global smartphone sales will decline by 14% in 2026.

We do not expect Apple to hike price intra-cycle like peers, but rather to continue driving ASP uplift through mix shift toward higher-end Pro, Pro Max models, and larger storage configurations. In the US, April iPhone sales declined 7% YoY, with unit shipments down 13% and ASP increasing 6%. The YoY weakness in US primarily reflects a tough comp due to demand pull-forward in April 2025. In China, iPhone sales rose 5.6% YoY in April, driven entirely by higher ASPs, with unit volumes largely flat.

Despite a solid start, 17e demand has trailed 16e during the first seven weeks, partly due to less aggressive North American carrier promotions and a prepaid channel that remains more concentrated around the 16e. However, when considering total **iPhone “e”-series sales (16e plus 17e)**, the last two months since the 17e launch are up vs. same period last year.

Sell-in and sell-through units were up 3% YoY, reflecting a strong iPhone 17 cycle. Inventory units increased MoM due to sell-through units below sell-in, and we see a meaningful uptick in inventory weeks.

For foundry/TSMC: weaker performance of iPhone 17e dragged the momentum of TSMC's N3P, but we believe overall Apple still holds up better vs. its smartphone peers. Even if Apple or any mobile customers release leading-node capacity, the capacity will be refilled by AI applications and TSMC won't experience revenue loss.

For Memory: the DRAM content YoY increase was 26% in April, vs. 20% increase from 2024 to 2025 on full-year basis. We will monitor how recent memory price hike affects the trend in the future.

For the rest of Apple's supply chain: channel check suggests the shipment of foldable phone is likely to be delayed, while the product launch is still targeted in Sep. Despite that, we still expect suppliers to Apple will outperform Android's this year, benefiting **Luxshare**. For **Sony**, however, there will likely be no upgrades in CIS this year, and we see higher risk of share loss to Samsung in 2027. For **Qualcomm**, strong performance from iPhone 17 base and pro models may be helpful in the near term, though Android performance appears to be suffering on the back of rising memory prices and Apple share gains (neither of which is positive, especially as Apple increasingly internalizes over time).

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	2 Jun 2026		Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
		Cur	Closing Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
AAPL (Apple)	O	USD	315.20	350.00	26.9%	USD	7.46	8.87	10.65	42.3	35.5	29.6
SNDK (SanDisk)	O	USD	1,716.36	1,700.00	4313.7%	USD	2.99	64.73	200.47	574.0	26.5	8.6
QCOM (Qualcomm)	M	USD	240.84	140.00	33.5%	USD	12.03	10.64	9.77	20.0	22.6	24.6
AVGO (Broadcom)	O	USD	481.57	525.00	59.3%	USD	6.82	11.38	17.73	70.6	42.3	27.2
2330.TT (TSMC)	O	TWD	2,425.00	2,780.00	104.5%	TWD	66.25	101.62	124.63	11.6	8.6	6.6
TSM (TSMC)	O	USD	446.69	430.00	97.8%	USD	10.50	16.11	19.75	13.5	10.0	7.6
000660.KS (SK hynix)	O	KRW	2,324,000	1,150,000	969.2%	KRW	60,341	286,732	385,594	38.5	8.1	6.0
005930.KS (SEC- Samsung)	O	KRW	362,500	225,000	487.4%	KRW	6,611.53	35,740	49,548	54.8	10.1	7.3
005935.KS (SEC-Pref - Samsung)	O	KRW	231,500	191,250	348.7%	KRW	6,611.53	35,740	49,548	35.0	6.5	4.7
SMSN.LI (Samsung)	O	USD	5,905.00	3,888.00	427.5%	USD	116.15	617.62	856.24	50.8	9.6	6.9
MU (Micron)	O	USD	1,064.10	510.00	912.5%	USD	8.29	62.53	121.03	128.4	17.0	8.8
2454.TT (MediaTek)	O	TWD	4,545.00	4,380.00	205.7%	TWD	66.17	69.52	170.50	68.7	65.4	26.7
SONY (Sony)	M	USD	22.79	22.00	(40.9)%	USD	1.08	1.25	1.30	21.2	18.3	17.5
6758.JP (Sony)	M	JPY	3,619.00	3,500.00	(46.6)%	JPY	171.30	198.75	207.66	21.1	18.2	17.4
3008.TT (Largan)	M	TWD	3,985.00	2,600.00	26.3%	TWD						
002475.CH (Luxshare)	O	CNY	74.80	86.00	95.9%	CNY	2.26	2.66	3.45	33.1	28.1	21.7
2382.HK (Sunny Optical)	O	HKD	84.35	76.00	(10.8)%	CNY	4.25	3.39	4.46	17.1	21.5	16.3
SPX			7,609.78									
ASIA			2,056.69									
EM			1,904.43									
JPL			2,575.72									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

AAPL, SNDK, QCOM, AVGO, MU estimate is Adjusted EPS; AAPL, SNDK, QCOM, AVGO, MU valuation is Adjusted P/E (x); 2330.TT, TSM valuation is P/B (x); 3008.TT base year is 1999;

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

Apple: As the gateway to the Intelligence revolution benefiting from stronger than expected iPhone 17 demand, we rate AAPL Outperform with a price target of \$350.

SanDisk: We rate SNDK Outperform with a price target of \$1700.

Samsung Electronics: We rate Samsung Electronics Outperform with price target of KRW225,000.

SK hynix : We rate SK hynix Outperform with price target of KRW1,150,000.

Micron: We rate Micron Outperform with price target of US\$510.00.

TSMC: We rate TSMC Outperform with price target of NT\$2,780.00.

MediaTek: We rate MediaTek Outperform with price target of NT\$4,380.00.

Sunny Optical: We rate Sunny Optical Outperform, with PT = HK\$76.00.

Luxshare: We rate Luxshare Outperform, with PT = RMB86.00.

Largan: We rate Largan Market-Perform, with PT = HK\$2,600.00.

Sony: We rate Sony (6748.JP) Market-Perform, PT = JPY 3,500.00.

QCOM (MP, \$140): Memory headwinds appear likely to pressure smartphone builds and numbers appear high; cheap valuation may not be enough to attract buyers.

AVGO (OP, \$525): A strong 2025 AI trajectory seems set to accelerate into 2026 and beyond, bolstered by software, cash deployment, and superb margins & FCF.

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DETAILS

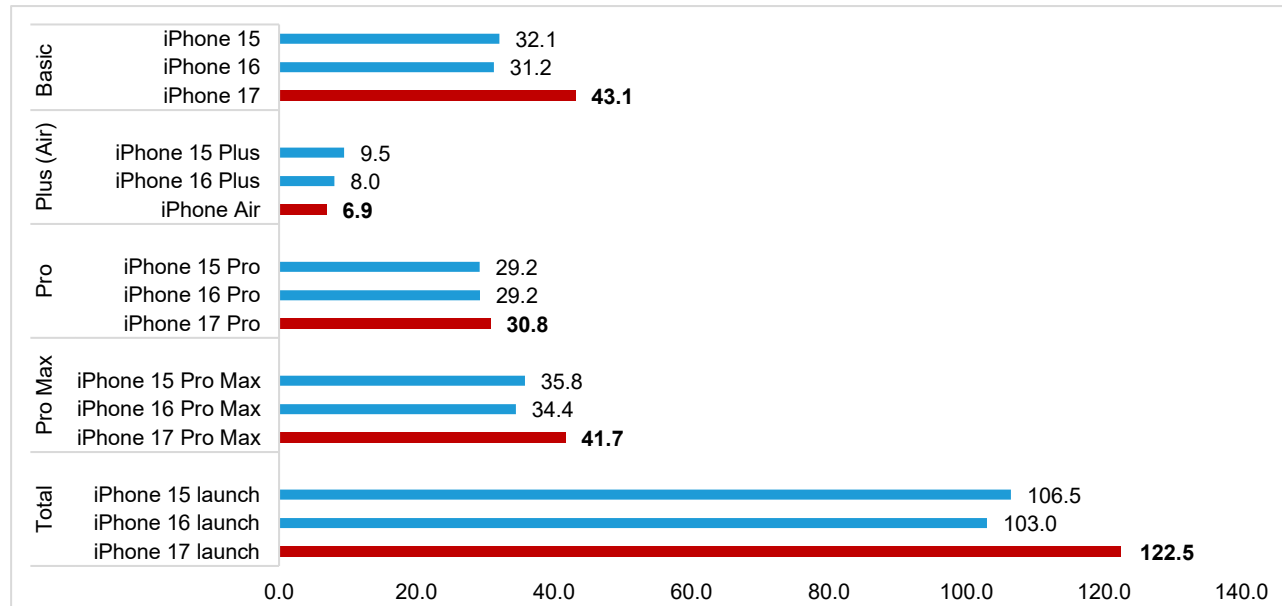
1. IPHONE PERFORMANCE REMAINED SOLID: GLOBAL REVENUE ROSE 5.6% YOY, UNIT VOLUMES UP 2.5% YOY, AND ASP UP 3%.

State of the Union - Counterpoint's latest Smartphone Market Outlook Tracker now forecasts full-year 2026 shipments to decline 13.9% YoY to 1.08 billion units, a further downgrade from the 12.4% contraction projected in February. The weakness is skewed toward lower-end devices, where demand and viability are deteriorating most sharply.

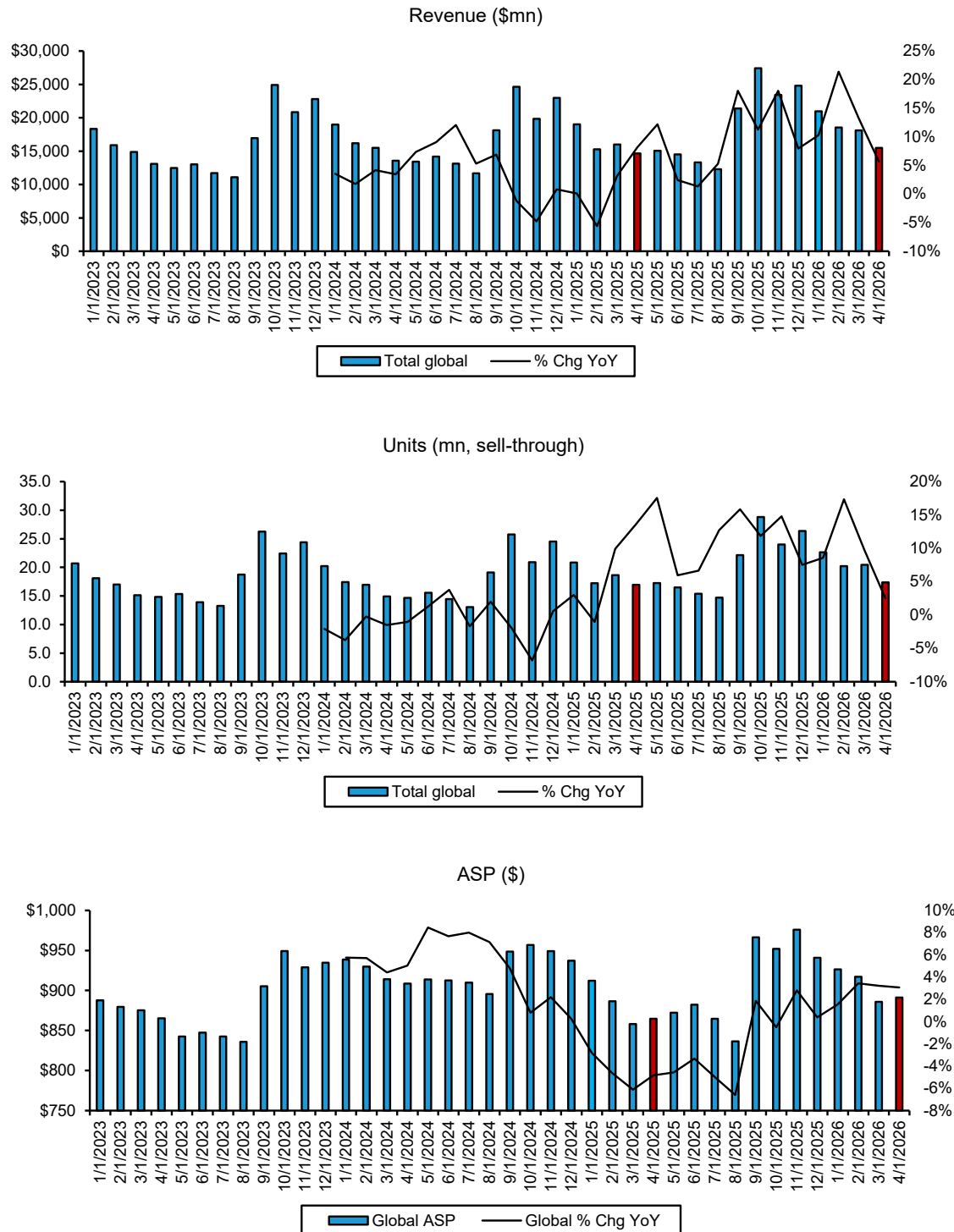
Globally, smartphone wholesale prices rose 14% in Q1, with upward pressure expected to persist as pre-shock inventory is depleted. Several sub-\$150 price tiers are facing what appears to be a structural, potentially permanent exit from the market. In contrast, the premium segment is proving more resilient. Apple and Samsung remain best positioned, supported by integrated supply chains and established premiumization strategies. **Apple, in particular, is unlikely to raise prices mid-cycle, instead relying on a continued mix shift toward higher-end Pro and Pro Max models, including larger memory configurations. In April, iPhone performance remained solid: global sell-through revenue rose 5.6% YoY, unit volumes increased 2.5% YoY, and ASPs climbed 3%.**

In the US, April iPhone sales declined 7% YoY, with unit shipments down 13% and ASP increasing 6%. The YoY weakness primarily reflects a tough comp due to demand pull-forward in April 2025. iPhone 17e performance has been solid, but promotional activity has been less aggressive relative to the 16e last year, contributing to the decline. Promotions from both Verizon and T-Mobile on Apple and Samsung devices have moderated. In prepaid, demand continues to consolidate around the iPhone 16e as sales of older models such as the iPhone 14 and 15 slow further. Cricket shifted away from promoting the iPhone 13 in April and is now featuring the 16e as its flagship Apple offering. The 17e remains primarily positioned in postpaid, though it is expected to see broader prepaid distribution later in the year.

In China, iPhone sales rose 5.6% YoY in April, driven entirely by higher ASPs, with unit volumes largely flat. There were no major Apple-led discount events in the market, though the national trade-in and recycling subsidy program remained active. For the upcoming 618 festival, promotions began around May 15, 2026, including an [RMB 1,000 price cut](#) on the iPhone 17 Pro across platforms such as JD.com and Tmall.

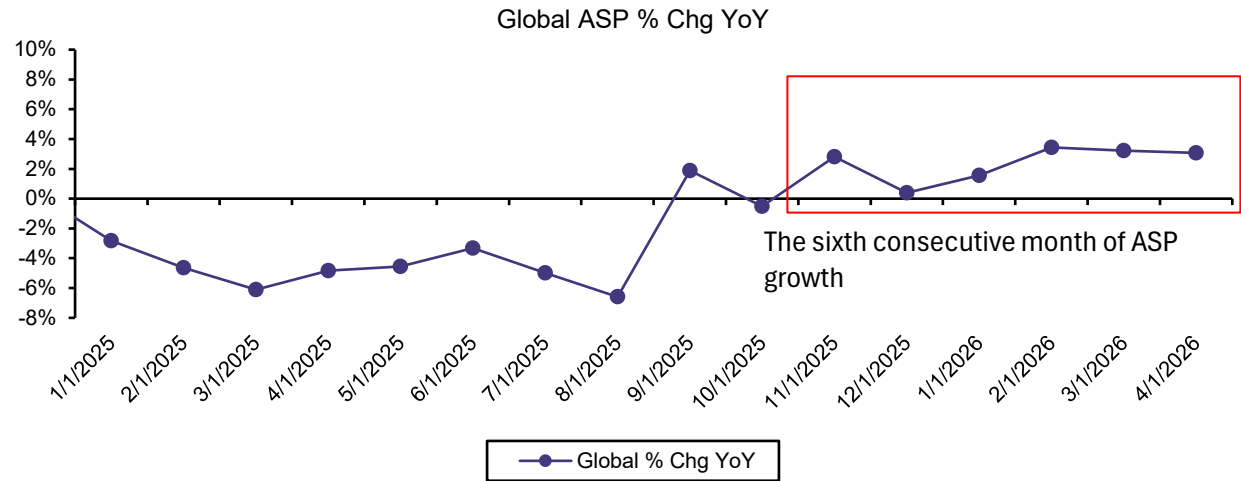
EXHIBIT 1: **Sell-thru Units (mn) in the first 8 months of launch - iPhone 17 vs. Past Cycles**

Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 2: Global iPhone revenue, units, ASP


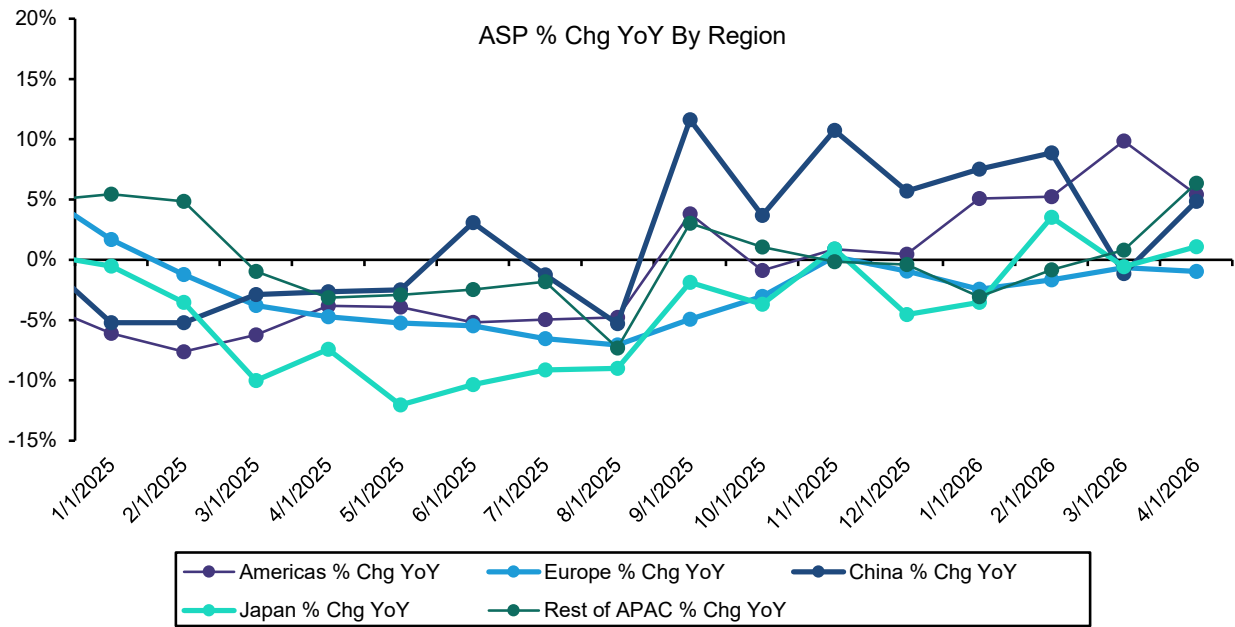
Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 3: Global ASP % Change YoY



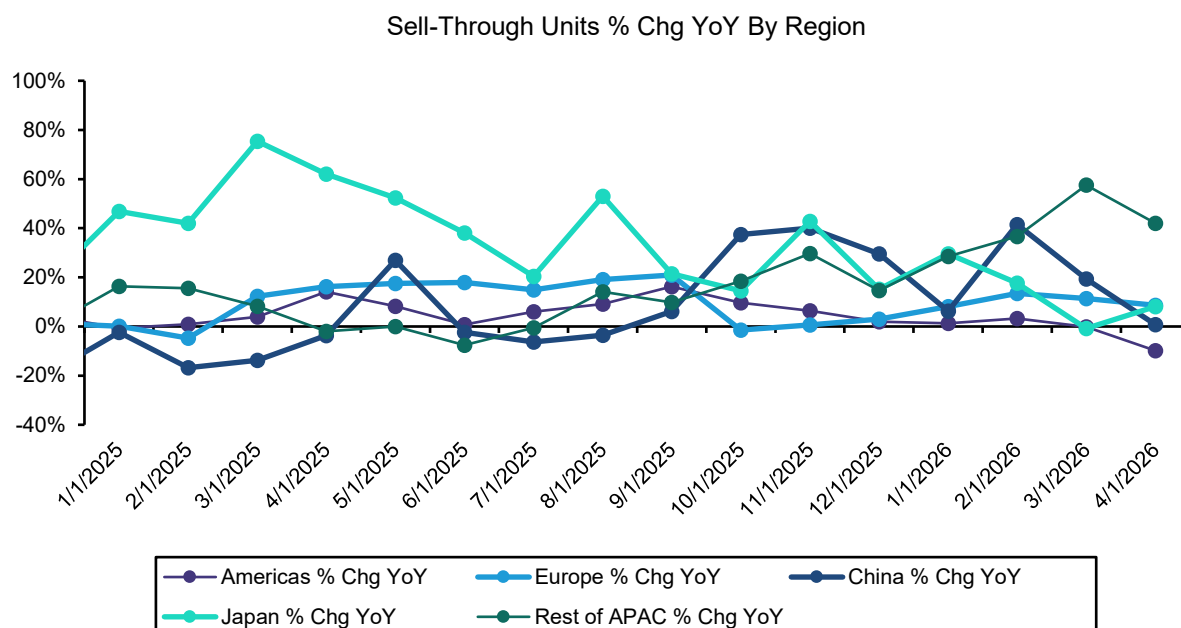
Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 4: ASP % Change YoY By Region



Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 5: Sell-thru units % chg by region



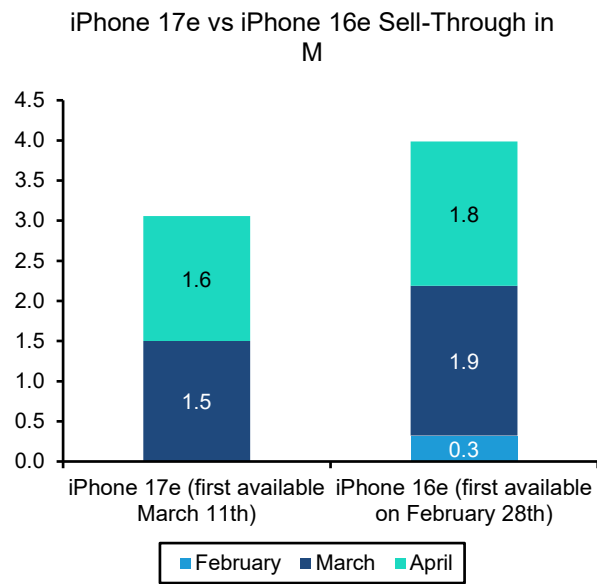
Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein analysis

2. IPHONE 17E'S PERFORMANCE IS WEAKENING VS IPHONE 16E IN YOY COMPARISON

While the iPhone 17e initially appeared to be tracking ahead of the iPhone 16e on a daily unit basis in the early weeks of launch, the inclusion of April data points to weaker relative performance versus the 16e. In April 2026, 17e units came in at 1.6mn, below the 1.8mn for the 16e in April 2025, which brings the 17e average daily units to 60k across March-April 2026, below the 16e's 64.29k across its February-April 2025 launch window, implying a 6.7% decline. Despite a solid start, 17e demand has trailed the 16e during the first seven weeks, partly due to less aggressive North American carrier promotions and a prepaid channel that remains more concentrated around the 16e.

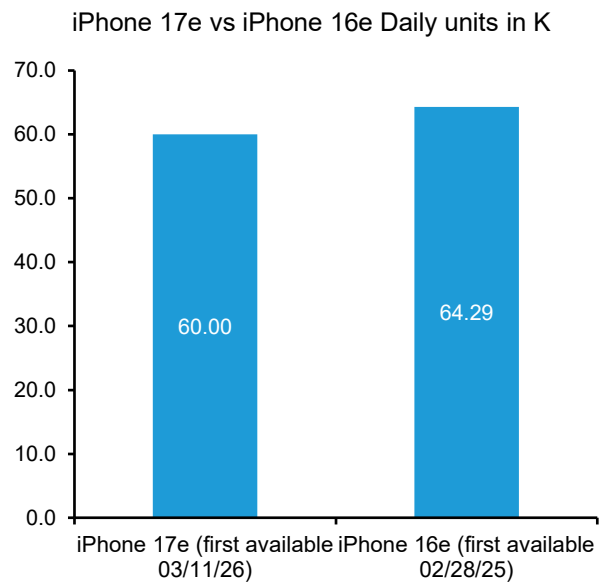
However, on a combined basis, iPhone e-series sales were higher in March and April 2026 than in the same period of 2025, with 16e and 17e combined sell-through reaching 4.2m units in 2026 versus 3.7m units last year, or roughly 14% year-over-year growth. Importantly, 2025 only had the 16e in market, while 2026 includes both the 16e and 17e, giving consumers a choice across two models; therefore, looking only at 17e versus 16e can understate underlying demand, whereas combined e-series sales suggest 2026 is the stronger cycle, with 4.2m units sold in March-April versus 3.7m in the prior year.

EXHIBIT 6: iPhone 17e vs iPhone 16e Sell-Through in M



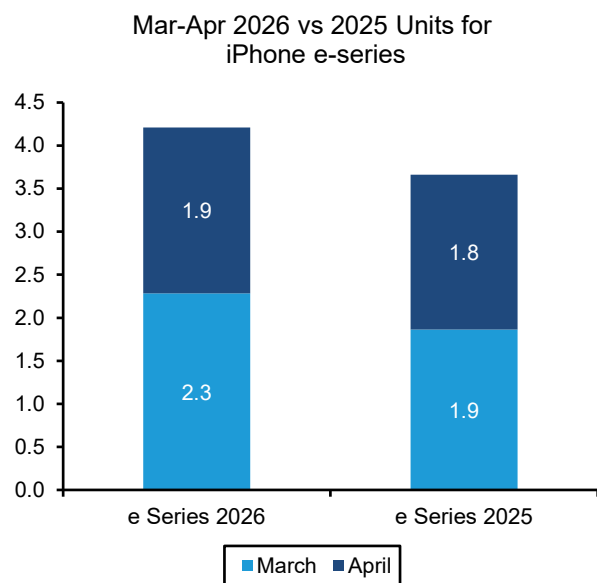
Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 7: iPhone 17e vs iPhone 16e Daily units in K



Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 8: Across March and April, the iPhone e-series had a total of 4.2m units in 2026 and 3.7m units in 2025, with 2026 outperforming



Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein analysis

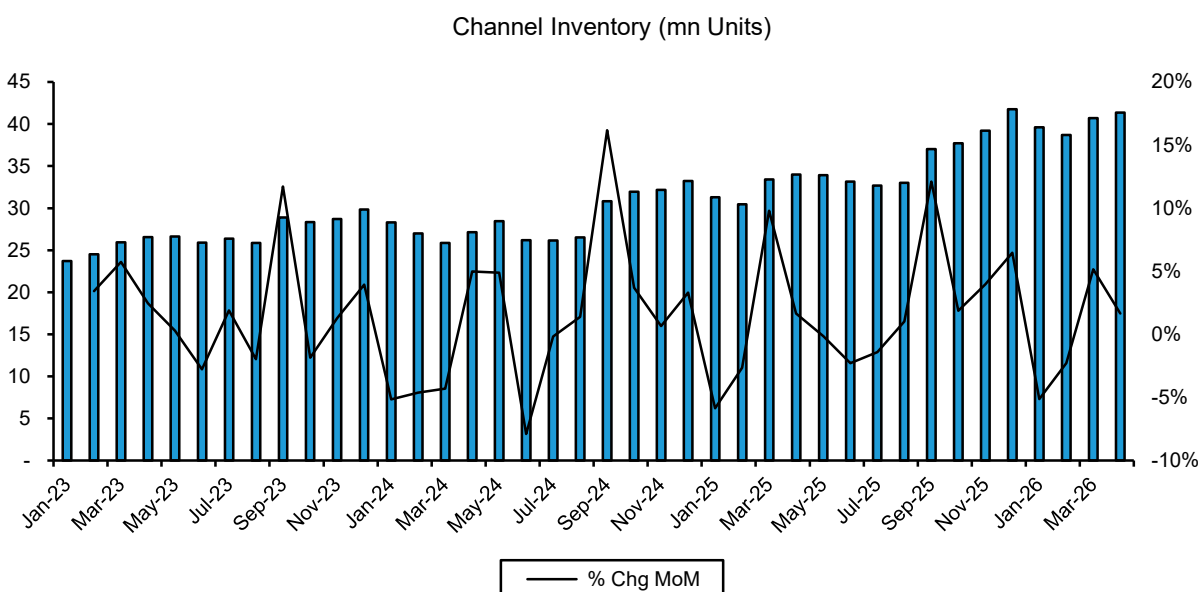
3. CHANNEL INVENTORY ELEVATED

Global iPhone sell-in and sell-through units dropped sequentially in April, but units are still up 3% YoY, reflecting a strong iPhone 17 cycle. Inventory units increased MoM due to weaker sell-through than sell-in. Moreover, we see a meaningful uptick in inventory weeks.

iPhone units declined MoM, but both sell-in and sell-through in April rose by 3% YoY. In April, Global iPhone sell-in units declined by 20% while sell-through decreased by 15% MoM. However, both sell-in and sell-through units rose by 3% compared to April 25 ([Exhibit 9](#)). Despite the MoM decline, it appears that the iPhone 17 series remains the key growth driver with continued momentum adding to YoY growth.

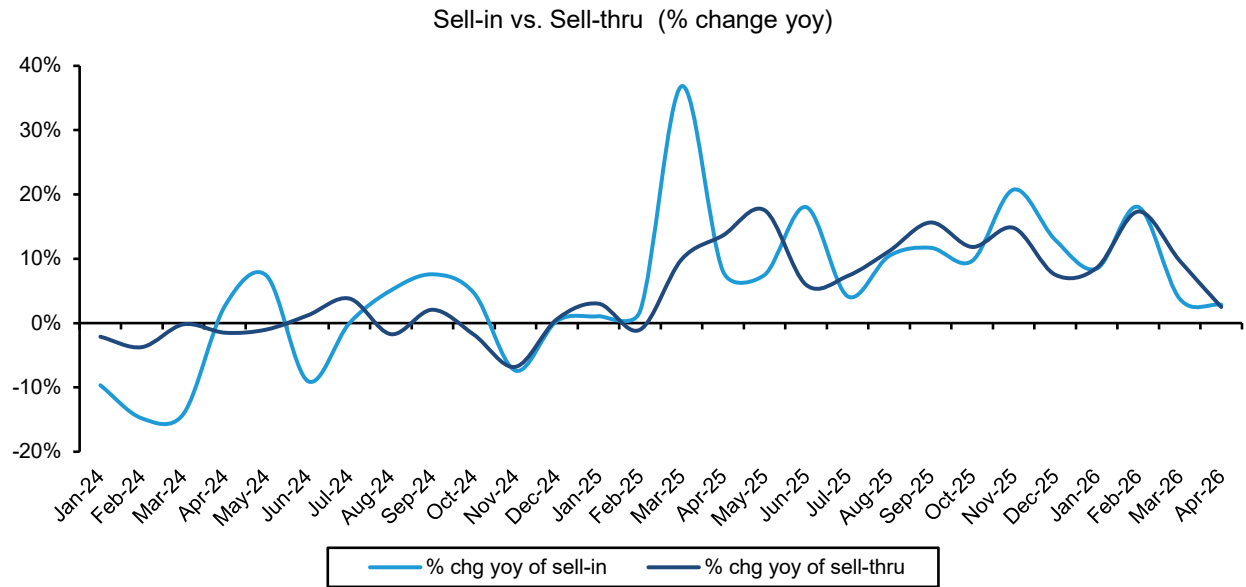
Inventory weeks increased meaningfully in April. With sell-in of 18.0mn running modestly above sell-through of 17.4mn, channel inventory units rose 2% MoM to 41.4mn ([Exhibit 9-Exhibit 11](#)), while inventory weeks climbed to 10.3x from 8.6x in March and versus 8.7x in April 2025 ([Exhibit 12](#)). Although some increase in inventory weeks from March to April is consistent with normal seasonality, the magnitude of this year's step-up appears relatively large relative to prior years and is more notable given that April 2025 likely already had higher inventory from tariff-related buffering. The elevated inventory weeks were driven primarily by weaker sell-through, as sell-through declined 15% MoM while channel inventory units increased only 2% MoM.

EXHIBIT 9: **Channel Inventory mn Units**



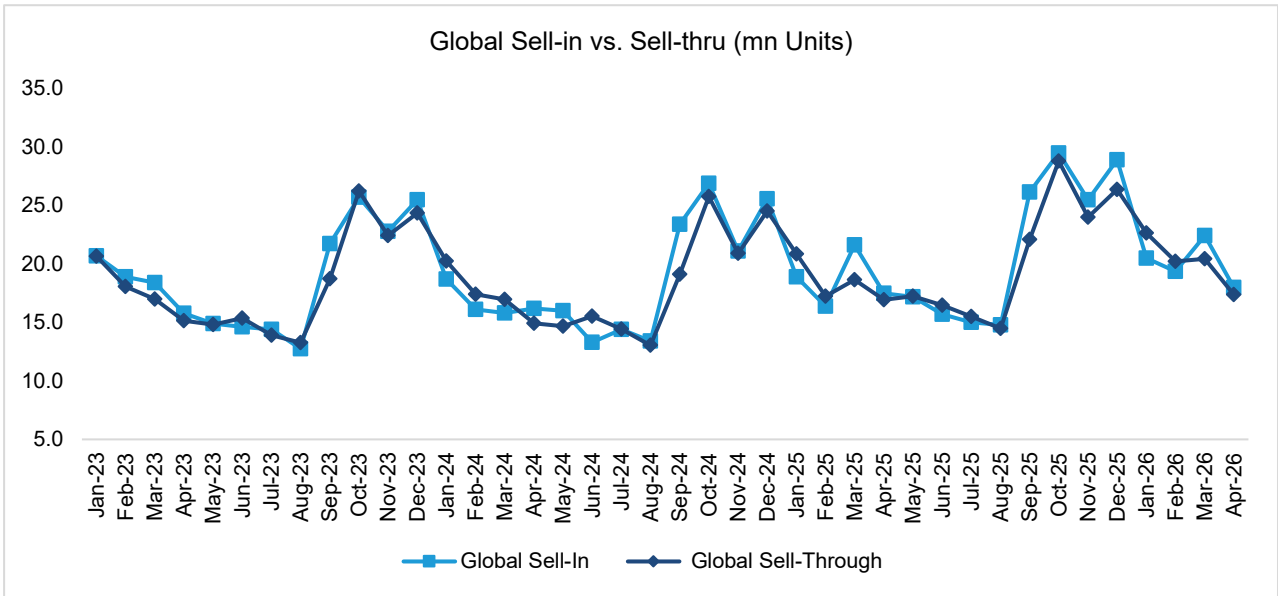
Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 10: Global Sell-in vs Sell-thru (mn Units)

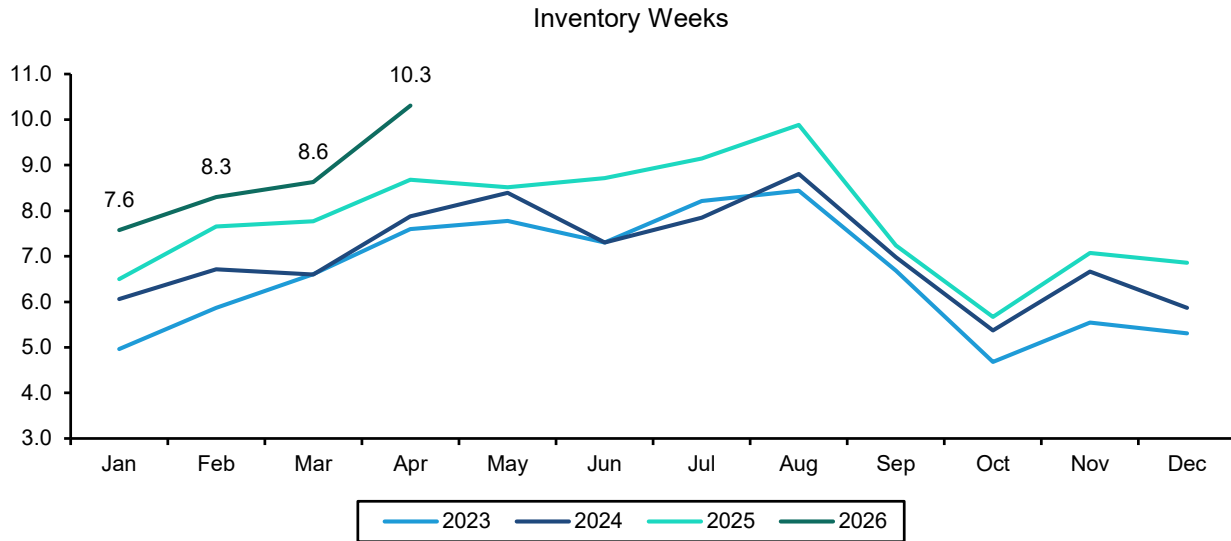


Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 11: Global Sell-in vs. Sell-thru (mn Units)



Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 12: **Inventory Weeks**

Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein analysis

4: FOUNDRY & MEMORY - POSITIVE FOR DEMAND AND CONTENT**FOUNDRY**

Exhibit 13 summarizes how monthly iPhone sales volume changed over years, and more importantly for TSMC how this volume changed for the process nodes used by iPhones. The “M” on the x-axis denotes the month when a main node first entered the market but possible enhancements over the main node (e.g. N5P in 2021 & N4 in 2022 over N5 in 2020) are also distinguished by their respective launch years, so that investors can get an idea how the momentum in each year differed from in prior years. Generally, sales volume experienced a significant surge in the first quarter following the initial delivery, then gradually declined eventually to below 1M units per month over c. 4 years. When a processor node or its variants was used across multiple iPhone generations, sales volume often saw a resurgence later. For instance, the 2022 N5 variant (i.e. N4P) was introduced first with the iPhone 14 Pro & Pro Max in Sept. 2022, and then used again in the iPhone 15 & 15 Plus released in Sept. 2023, and that resulted in a reversal of the declining trend 12 months after the initial launch (M+12).

Zooming to iPhone 17, we first find that the new iPhone 17 series & iPhone Air are all built on the same generation of N3 node (reportedly N3P). This is hence most comparable to 2024 when all iPhone 16 models launched in late 2024 were all on the generation (reportedly N3E) prior to N3P. Comparing these cycles, iPhone 17 initially showed a solid ramp, outrunning iPhone 16 in volume at the same stage. However, weaker-than-expected sales of the iPhone 17e versus the 16e have made the iPhone 17 (N3P) cycle roughly equal to the iPhone 16 (N3E) one.

Exhibit 14 presents a similar comparison of iPhone sales trends, but broken down by mobile processor. “M” on the x-axis again denotes the month when each processor was first released & delivered with product. The data indicates that the weakness is concentrated in the A19 (used in iPhone 17e), while sales volume of the A19 Pro in Pro & Air models remains ahead of that of A18 Pro.

Looking into 2H26, iPhone processors will migrate wafer node from N3 to N2 and packaging technology from InFO (Integrated Fan-Out) to WMCM (Wafer-Level Multi-Chip Module). Both should allow TSMC to enjoy a content increase. TSMC flagged the softening smartphone demand due to elevated memory price, but revised up its 2026 revenue guidance from “close to 30%” to “over 30%” as the “step-up” in AI demand is more than enough to offset the shortfall. Our channel checks suggest that Apple is exploring Intel Foundry for chip production. We see the likelihood of Apple becoming a customer of Intel Foundry, but we believe it’s mainly on geopolitical considerations. Samsung foundry gain some traction on the fundamental side, but on a bit older technology generations. As a result, TSMC is expected to remain the exclusive foundry for iPhone processors for the foreseeable future.

MEMORY

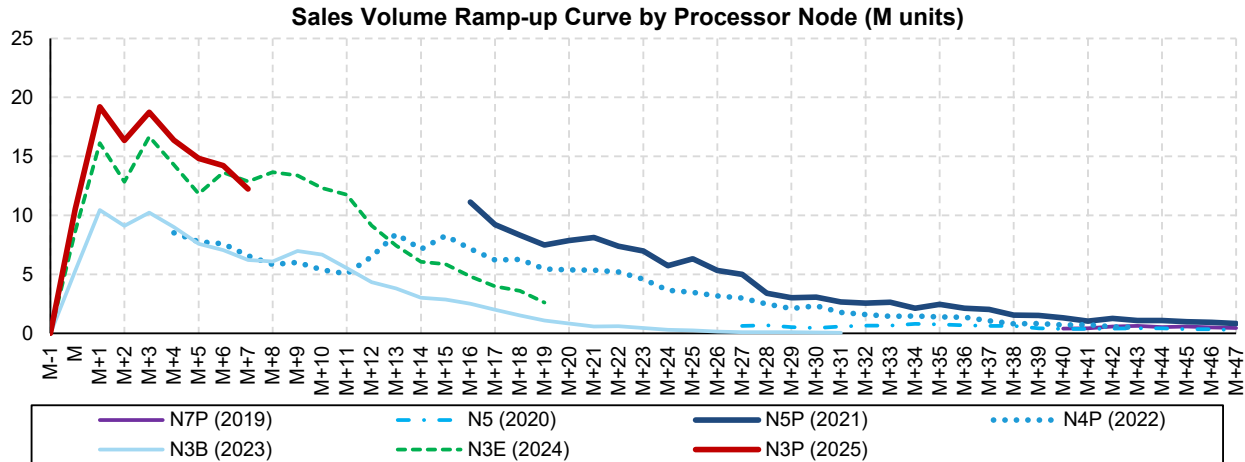
[Exhibit 16](#) summarizes the DRAM size of all iPhone models since iPhone 11, including 8GB of iPhone 17e that Apple launched not long ago. Likely with the need to support on-device AI, Apple appears to be adding DRAM content at an accelerating pace and we will monitor closely if this trend will be affected the recent memory price increase. Apple upgraded Pro models to 8GB DRAM starting iPhone 15 series and then all models to 8GB DRAM in iPhone 16 series. With iPhone 17 series, most models received another 50% boost to 12GB. For the first 8 months of 2025, over 80% of the iPhone sales was equipped with 8GB as the majority of the sales was iPhone 16 series. After the launch of iPhone 17 series in September 2025, the portion of iPhones shipped with 12GB DRAM increased quickly to nearly 50% of the total iPhone shipment ([Exhibit 17](#)). In terms of the average DRAM content, 2024 saw solid 18% growth, thanks to the upgrade from iPhone 16 series. 2025 saw another 20% growth to 8.4GB, thanks to another material upgrade to 12GB for the Pro and Air models.

In April, mix of 12GB models increased slightly to 42% of the overall iPhone shipment, though it remained lower than levels prior to Feb, due to the inclusion of iPhone 17e in the mix starting Mar. Models with 8GB+ DRAM stayed at 95% of the total shipment. The average DRAM content was at 9.5GB, flattish MoM but still kept the YoY increase at 26% ([Exhibit 18](#)). Starting from Sep this year, the high base starting in Sep 2025 may make the YoY growth rate moderate. Beyond that, we also wonder whether the high memory price will affect memory content increase.

We estimate 2025 overall smartphone content growth was close to 10% (see our DRAM industry model [here](#)). As iPhone contributed to around 15% of all smartphone DRAM demand (thus ~5% of the entire DRAM demand), our current model implicitly assumes non-iPhone smartphones had a slower content increase, a bit under 8%, in 2025. For 2026 our current projection has ~8% DRAM content growth for all smartphones, slower than 2025 due to considerably higher memory cost.

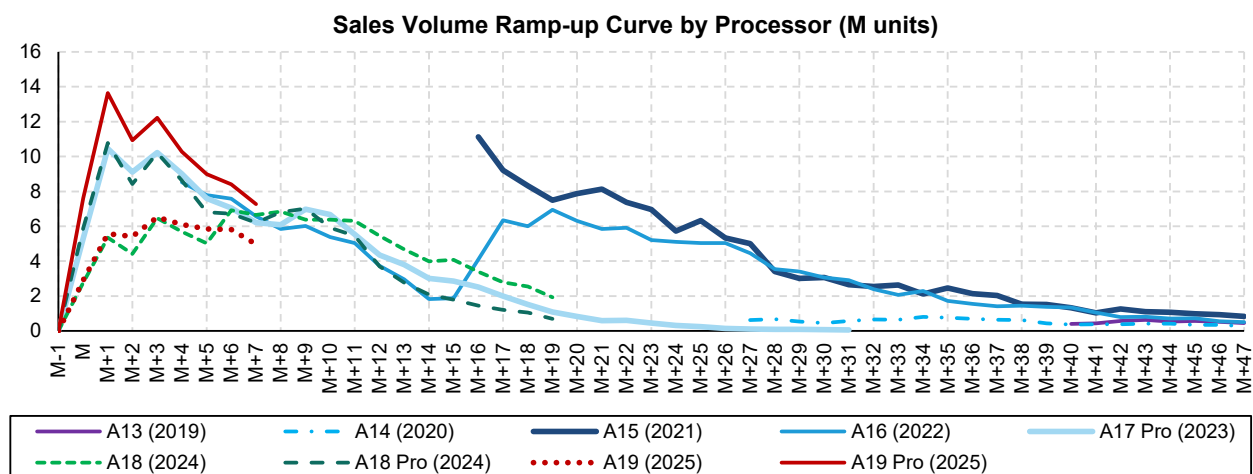
What's perhaps more relevant now is how smartphone demand may be impacted due to price increase as a result of memory cost increase. YTD, iPhone shipment YoY growth remained very robust with Jan-Apr up 9% YoY. We believe the memory cost to pressure on many smartphone OEMs, but iPhone will be more resilient, in light of its high profitability to absorb cost increases.

EXHIBIT 13: **Weak sales performance of iPhone 17e dragged the shipment of N3P.**



Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 14: **A similar comparison on iPhone mobile processors shows that the weakness mainly came from A19, while A19 Pro for Pro SKU remained resilient.**



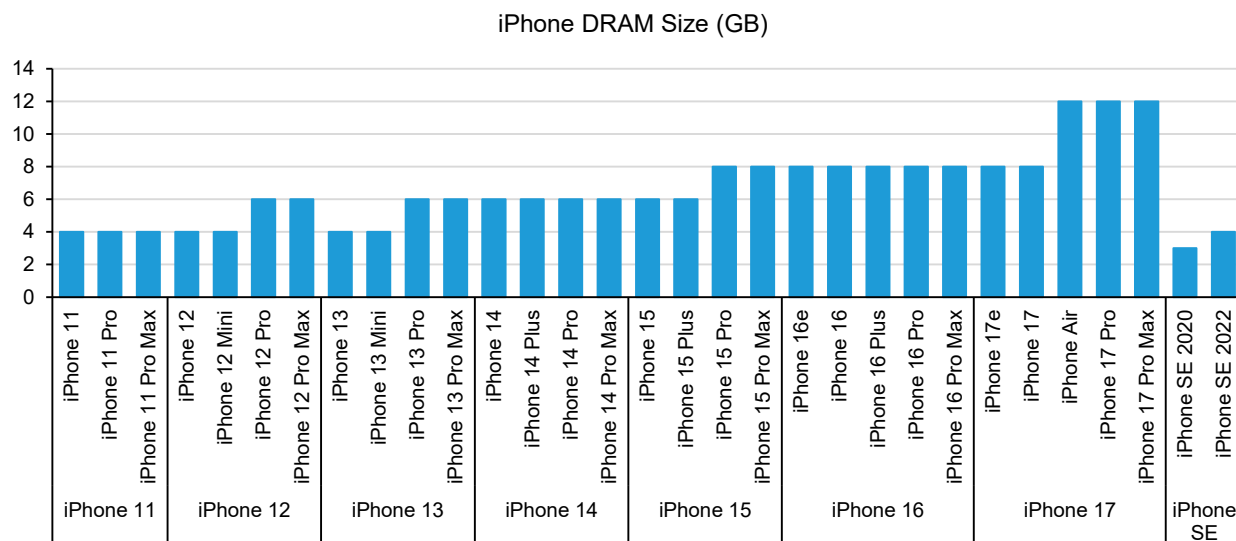
Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 15: **Summary of iPhone processors and their respective technology node**

Model	First Delivery Time (YYYY-MM-DD)	Processor	Node
iPhone 17e	2026-03-11	A19	N3P
iPhone 17 Pro Max	2025-09-19	A19 Pro	N3P
iPhone 17 Pro	2025-09-19	A19 Pro	N3P
iPhone Air	2025-09-19	A19 Pro	N3P
iPhone 17	2025-09-19	A19	N3P
iPhone 16e	2025-02-28	A18	N3E
iPhone 16 Pro Max	2024-09-20	A18 Pro	N3E
iPhone 16 Pro	2024-09-20	A18 Pro	N3E
iPhone 16 Plus	2024-09-20	A18	N3E
iPhone 16	2024-09-20	A18	N3E
iPhone 15 Pro Max	2023-09-22	A17 Pro	N3B
iPhone 15 Pro	2023-09-22	A17 Pro	N3B
iPhone 15 Plus	2023-09-22	A16	N4P
iPhone 15	2023-09-22	A16	N4P
iPhone 14 Pro Max	2022-09-16	A16	N4P
iPhone 14 Pro	2022-09-16	A16	N4P
iPhone 14 Plus	2022-10-07	A15	N5P
iPhone 14	2022-09-16	A15	N5P
iPhone SE 2022	2022-03-18	A15	N5P
iPhone 13 Pro Max	2021-09-24	A15	N5P
iPhone 13 Pro	2021-09-24	A15	N5P
iPhone 13	2021-09-24	A15	N5P
iPhone 13 Mini	2021-09-24	A15	N5P
iPhone 12 Pro Max	2020-11-13	A14	N5
iPhone 12 Pro	2020-10-23	A14	N5
iPhone 12	2020-10-23	A14	N5
iPhone 12 Mini	2020-11-13	A14	N5
iPhone SE 2020	2020-04-24	A13	N7P
iPhone 11 Pro Max	2019-09-20	A13	N7P
iPhone 11 Pro	2019-09-20	A13	N7P
iPhone 11	2019-09-20	A13	N7P

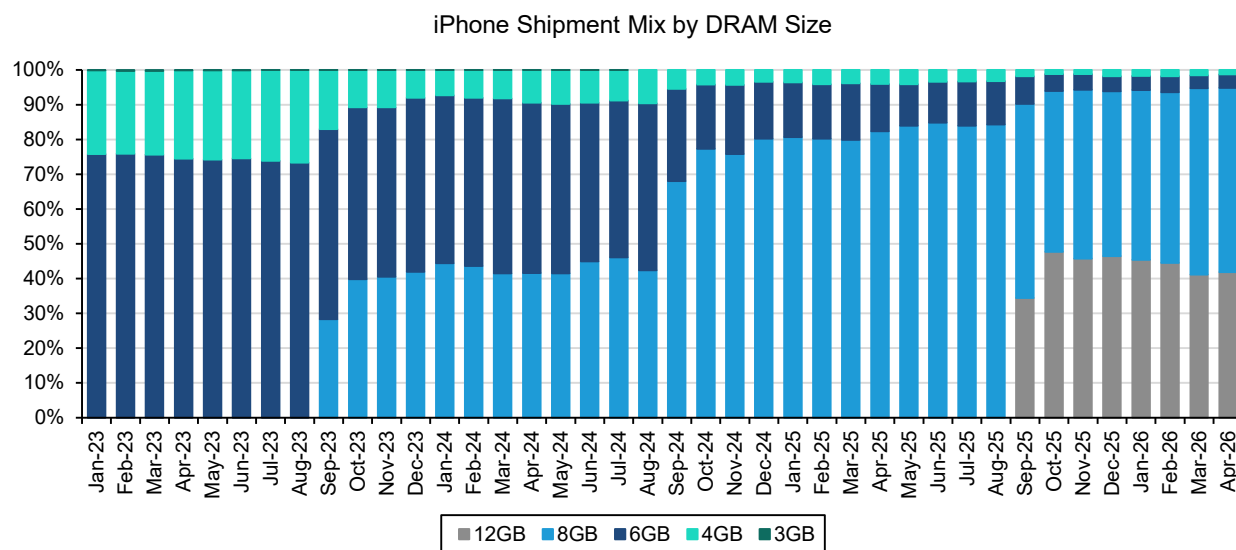
Source: Company websites, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 16: Most of iPhone 17 models feature 12GB DRAM vs. 8GB for iPhone 16 series, likely to better support on-device AI.



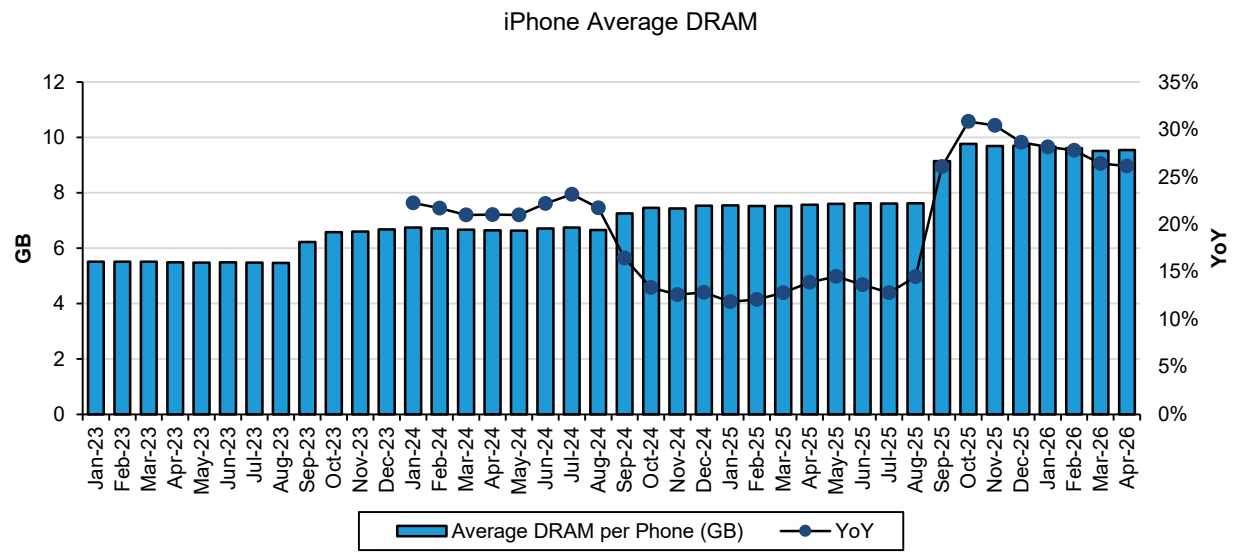
Source: iFixit, GSMArena and Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 17: iPhone models with 12GB DRAM improved slightly MoM to 42% of the overall shipment.



Source: Counterpoint, iFixit and Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 18: The average DRAM content per phone still remained largely steady MoM at 9.5GB in Apr, still up meaningfully YoY by 26%.



Source: Counterpoint, iFixit and Bernstein analysis

5. IPHONE DEMAND BY REGION

EXHIBIT 19: Americas iPhone total revenue, units and ASP



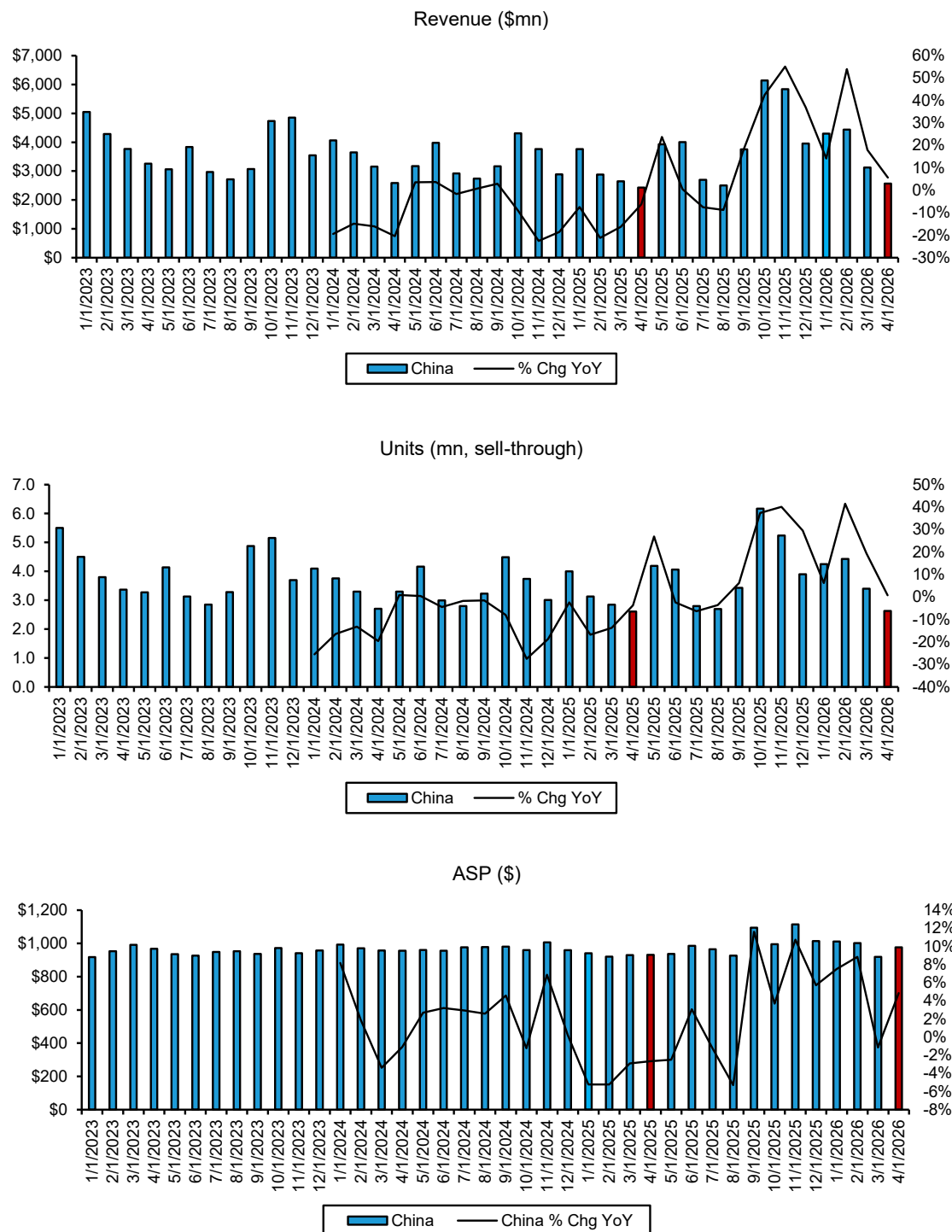
Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 20: Europe iPhone revenue, units and ASP



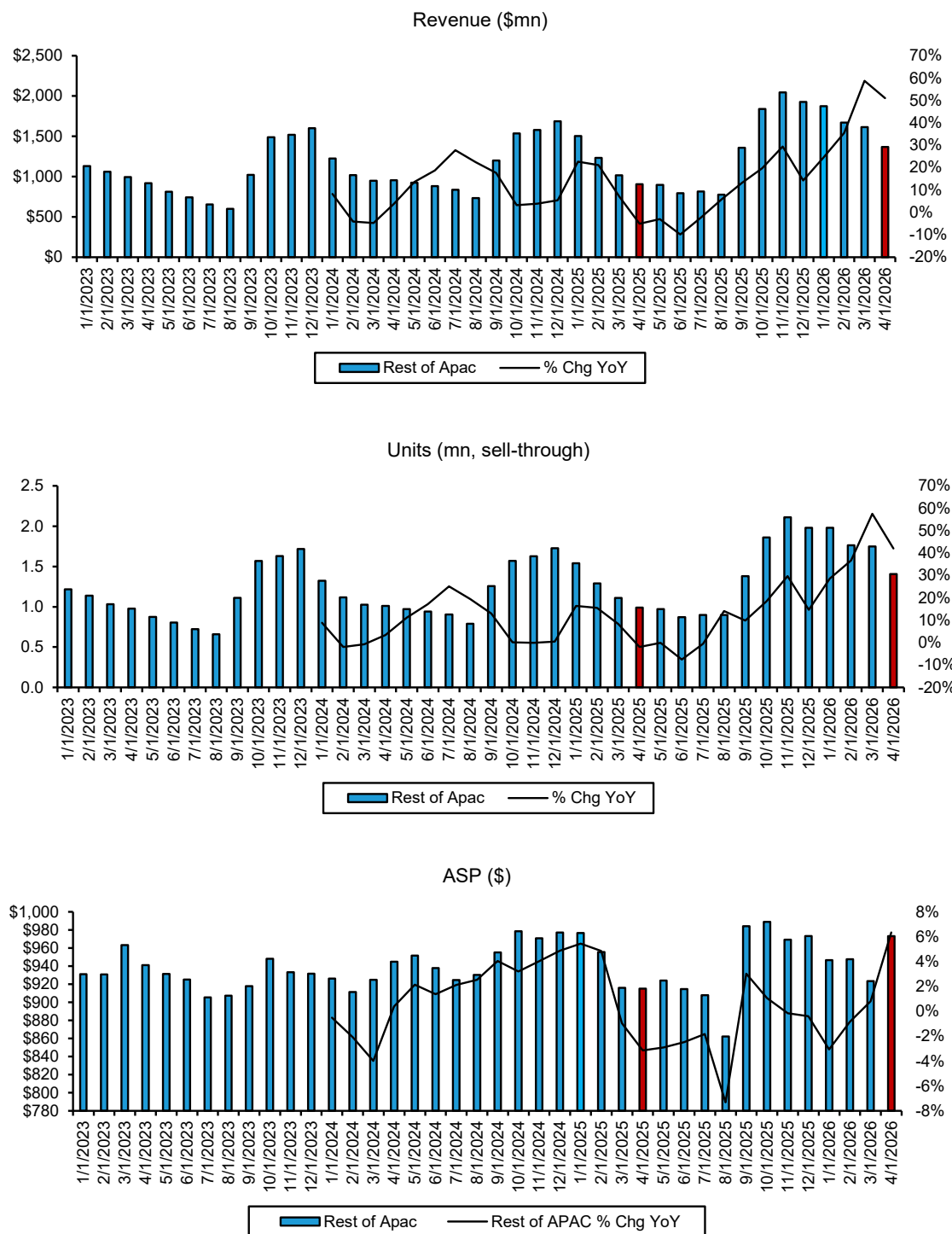
Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 21: **China iPhone revenue, units and ASP**



Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 22: Rest of Apac iPhone revenue, units, ASP



Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 23: Japan iPhone revenue, units, ASP



Source: Counterpoint, Bernstein Analysis

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

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